

Topic 5: Microsoft Copilot in Office 365

5.1 What is Microsoft 365 Copilot?

- Microsoft 365 Copilot integrates AI directly into Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, and OneNote
- Powered by GPT-4 with access to your organisation's own data via Microsoft Graph
- Pricing: Microsoft 365 Copilot costs \$30/user/month (requires an existing Microsoft 365 subscription)
- Key promise: AI that knows your organisation's documents, emails, meetings, and calendar
- Data security: your data stays within your Microsoft 365 tenant and is not used to train public models
- Microsoft Copilot (free): available at copilot.microsoft.com without a Microsoft 365 subscription

5.2 Copilot in Word and PowerPoint

- Word -- Draft: 'Write a project proposal for a new employee onboarding portal based on [document reference]'
- Word -- Rewrite: select any text and ask Copilot to change tone, shorten, expand, or simplify it
- Word -- Summarise: 'What are the 5 key decisions in this 40-page strategy document?'
- PowerPoint -- Create: 'Create a 10-slide presentation about sustainable packaging for a retail audience'
- PowerPoint -- Add slide: 'Add a slide comparing our Q3 and Q4 revenue based on this data'

5.3 Copilot in Excel and Outlook

- Excel -- Analysis: 'Show me the top 5 products by margin this quarter, and highlight any with declining trend'
- Excel -- Formulas: describe what you want to calculate; Copilot writes the formula and explains it
- Excel -- Data cleaning: 'Identify and flag duplicate customer entries in column A'
- Outlook -- Draft: Copilot drafts email replies in your writing style from bullet points
- Outlook -- Summarise: 'Summarise this 20-message email thread and list the open questions'

5.4 Copilot in Teams and Business Chat

- Teams: join a meeting late and ask Copilot 'Catch me up on the last 10 minutes'; get meeting summaries with action items
- Teams: 'What decisions were made in the #product channel this week?'
- Business Chat (BizChat): query across all M365 data -- 'What did we agree on the marketing budget in last month's meetings?'

- Copilot Pages: a collaborative canvas where you and AI build on generated content together
 - ROI consideration: the value depends heavily on how well your team documents work in M365 tools
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